

FRANCISCO FERNANDEZ

Senior Product Manager

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Manager with a background in web design and development going back to 1999. Self-taught, started building client sites at 14 before most of the tools and frameworks that exist today were around. Over 14 years at INAES I moved from Data Analyst to Product Designer to Product Lead, taking on end-to-end ownership of data-intensive platforms used by 22,000+ organizations.

Currently leading the architecture of an institutional AI transformation program covering 20 operational areas, including the design and implementation of domain-specific agents and the fine-tuning of LLMs on regulated financial documentation. The program was initiated based on a proposal I brought to executive leadership after identifying the strategic risk of outsourcing automation to external vendors.

Most of my work follows a consistent pattern: I take processes that force people to depend on others and turn them into systems where users can operate on their own. I work in regulated, operationally complex environments where the product is not optional and trust is not given for free.

I work in English and Spanish at the same level. Comfortable across US and LATAM time zones.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager / AI Program Architect 2020 - Present

INAES - National Institution of Associativism and Social Economy, Buenos Aires

Responsible for product strategy, roadmap definition, stakeholder alignment and delivery across critical data systems. Currently co-leading the design and implementation of an institutional AI transformation program. Full decision ownership at every stage of the product process.

Institutional AI Transformation Program

Proposed and designed a program to bring full governance of automation in-house after identifying the strategic and data security risks of outsourcing to external vendors. The proposal was accepted by executive leadership and became the institution's primary technology initiative for the next 12 months.

- Serving as AI architect within a three-person leadership team, responsible for the technical and product decisions that shape how the program is designed and executed across 20 operational areas.
- Designed the rollout strategy: a phased approach starting with a high-complexity pilot area (financial document analysis) to validate the model before scaling across the institution.
- Leading the implementation of a Llama 4 Maverick fine-tuning pipeline on a corpus of regulated financial documents (balance sheets), including definition of the training sample, training plan, and performance metrics.
- Designed a three-tier classification system (high, medium, low alert) based on data persistence thresholds, with automated flagging of documents that require human review.
- Defined the output layer: geographic, entity-type, and sector-level insights to support data-driven policy decisions at the institutional level.
- Established performance metrics: processing time, accuracy rate, and output efficacy, validated against a ground truth corpus of previously analyzed documents.
- Designed the AGENT.md framework used to configure domain-specific agents for each operational area, enabling consistent deployment across the program.
- Target outcome: reduce human analysis workload by 10x, redirecting staff from document processing to high-judgment tasks that require human expertise.

Data Platform Transformation / Legacy Modernization

- Led product discovery and roadmap definition to replace a file-based workflow that had been in place for over a decade, used by 22,000+ mandatory users across Argentina.
- Coordinated legal, operations and engineering teams throughout the transition with no disruption to existing workflows.
- Defined and executed the rollout strategy for a real-time transactional platform that removed all intermediate data processing steps.

Results

- 100% elimination of file-based workflows
- +25% data entry speed
- -12% error rate
- -35% support volume

AI-Powered Document Extraction Tool / Internal Tooling

- Spotted an automation opportunity during user research and replaced a 5 to 7 day manual indexing process with a browser-based self-service tool that runs in about 5 minutes.
- Defined the scope, architecture constraints and output requirements, then built and shipped the whole thing in a single session using AI-assisted development.
- Non-technical staff can now generate structured datasets on their own, with no installation or setup needed.

Product Designer & Web Developer 2017 - 2020

INAES - National Institution of Associativism and Social Economy, Buenos Aires

Took full ownership of digital products from problem scoping through design, development and delivery. Worked independently across the full lifecycle with no product management layer above, using Adobe XD and later Figma for UX/UI design.

- Designed and built the institutional intranet and a suite of internal tools.
- Redesigned the internal phone directory system, handling all decisions, stakeholder conversations and deployment on my own.
- Shifted the development stack toward React and Python/Django as more maintainable alternatives to the existing C# codebase.

Data Analyst 2011 - 2017

INAES - National Institution of Associativism and Social Economy, Buenos Aires

Came in for a document digitization project and within a few months was leading it. The original task was to load data into a system; I reframed it as a structural problem and built a loading framework that let HR work independently without having to check in with our team.

- Managed a set of cross-referenced Excel files tracking salary accreditation, headcount, project progress and geographic distribution of cooperatives and workers across Argentina.
- Automated the full reporting pipeline using Macros and VBA, reducing a multi-step manual process to a single button click for a team of 3 analysts.
- Cut reporting cycle time by around 50%, which gave operational teams much faster access to the data they needed for decisions.

Web Designer & Developer 1999 - 2011

Freelance

Started building websites at 14 out of personal interest, picked up the first client in 2000. Built direct-to-consumer storefronts using Shopify and WooCommerce for clients across different categories, alongside web design work on HTML/CSS, Flash, PHP, WordPress, Joomla and Blogspot.

Founder 2025 - Present

NDZ Labs

Founded and operate NDZ Labs, a Product Intelligence Company focused on researching, designing and validating modular operational systems for underserved industries. Built and piloting a booking platform for services businesses and designed a modular Dental Operation OS, structured for scalability and future

cross-industry adaptation. In NDZ Labs I lead product discovery, architecture, monetization strategy and validation while leveraging AI agents to compress execution cycles across design, development and operations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product: Product Strategy, Roadmapping, Product Lifecycle, KPI-Driven Decision Making, Product Discovery, OKRs, User Stories, Go-to-Market

AI and Automation: LLM Fine-tuning, Agent Design, AGENT.md Frameworks, AI-assisted Development, Process Automation, Document Intelligence

Design: UX/UI, Figma, Adobe XD, Wireframing, Prototyping, User Research

Leadership: Stakeholder Management, Cross-functional Leadership, Sprint Planning, Agile, Scrum

Data and Analytics: Metabase, Amplitude, A/B Testing, Excel, VBA, Data-driven Decision Making

Technical: System Design, API-based Architectures, React, Python, Django, Web Applications

Tools: Figma, Linear, Jira, Notion, Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Antigravity

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Product Management Fundamentals*In Progress*

University of Maryland / edX

UX/UI Design Certification*2025*

City Government of Buenos Aires

Continuous self-directed learning in web development, product design and data analysis since 1999.

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native

English: Fluent, C2 (EF SET)